

Computational Humour - Understanding and Designing Joke

Objective: Understand the basis of computational humor, research existing systems, and create a manual algorithm for generating a joke.

Background: Humor is a complex cognitive and emotional process, often considered uniquely human. With the rise of AI and computational models, there has been an interest in understanding and replicating humor algorithmically. Several systems have been developed to recognize, evaluate, and sometimes even produce humor. This assignment delves into the realm of computational humor to get a grasp of its intricacies.

Tasks:

Research: Start by investigating at least three computational systems or models that have been designed for humor recognition, evaluation, or production. Some starting points include:

- JAPE (Joke Analysis and Production Engine)
- STANDUP (System To Augment Non-speakers' Dialogue Using Puns)
- HAHAAcronym (A system to create humorous acronyms)
- GPT-3
- Bard
- ColBERT

For each system, highlight the following:

- Purpose (e.g., generating jokes, recognizing humor, etc.)
- Basic mechanism or methodology
- Strengths and limitations

Design a Manual Joke Algorithm: Based on your understanding, design a simple manual algorithm that could be used to generate a joke. This doesn't have to be computational or highly complex; it can be a series of logical or linguistic steps that lead to a punchline. For example:

- Choose a common scenario.
- Identify an unexpected twist or contradiction related to that scenario.
- Formulate a setup and punchline based on the above.

Submission:

Write the report must include

- Summaries of the three computational humour systems you researched.
- Your manual joke algorithm along with a sample joke it produces.
- Evaluation of your sample joke by a human audience.

Word Limit: Minimum 250 words.

Additional Notes:

- In your research, be sure to include both newer and older computational humor systems. This will give you a broader understanding of the field and its evolution.
- When designing your manual joke algorithm, be creative and try to come up with something unique. There are many different ways to generate a joke, so don't be afraid to experiment.
- When evaluating your sample joke with a human audience, be sure to get feedback from a variety of people, including people of different ages, genders, and cultural backgrounds. This will help you to get a more accurate assessment of the joke's humor.

Next page has an example of a manual algorithm

Example of a manual algorithm

Task: Fix your TV

